

Sermon Text Similarity Review

Fellowship Bible Church Tucson compared with Alistair Begg: A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 2, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 3

Prepared 2026-09-11 | Evidence review, not a legal or ecclesiastical verdict

Summary

8 of 9 sermon transcripts contain at least one exact run of 8+ consecutive words found in the source corpus. Matched words total 3,067 of 82,449 (3.72%). 6 sermon(s) exceed the project rubric. Suggested outcome: meets flag threshold - review the longest passages for Scripture/attribution before flagging.

Verbatim overlap is an indicator, not a finding. Scripture, hymns, creeds and prayers are shared language, and both transcripts may contain speech-recognition errors. The longest passages are listed so a reader can classify them in context.

Results by sermon

Sermon	Words	Best-matching source	Runs	Longest	Matched	Coverage
Big Mess 8-1-2026	3,364	Faith, Hope and Love (Alistair Begg)	0	0	0	0.00%
Faith, Hope and Love - 041926	10,180	Faith, Hope and Love (Alistair Begg)	38	19	363	3.57%
God's Word...Not Man's - 052426	11,715	God's Word... Not Man's (Alistair Begg)	46	26	499	4.26%
No Clever Tricks - 051026	10,026	No Clever Tricks (Alistair Begg)	54	31	525	5.24%
Our Glory and Joy - 053126	8,699	Our Glory and Joy (Alistair Begg)	51	25	564	6.48%
Sexual Purity - 062826	10,194	Sexual Purity, Part 1 (Alistair Begg)	21	25	207	2.03%
The Faithfulness of God - 072626	9,037	The Faithfulness of God (Alistair Begg)	65	19	583	6.45%
The Walk of Influence - 071926	9,528	Learning to Live in Peace (Alistair Begg)	4	10	38	0.40%
Your True Identity - 071226	9,706	The Coming of the Lord, Part 1 (Alistair Begg)	8	17	79	0.81%

Longest matching passages

Machine-normalised excerpts, longest first. Classify each as Scripture, liturgy or source commentary before citing it.

1. 42 consecutive words - Sermon: The Faithfulness of God - 072626 | Source: Sexual Purity, Part 1 (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 2)

"may god himself the god of peace sanctify you through and through may your whole spirit soul and body be kept blameless at the coming of our lord jesus christ the one who calls you is faithful and he will do it"

2. 31 consecutive words - Sermon: No Clever Tricks - 051026 | Source: No Clever Tricks (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"i do not even judge myself my conscience is clear but that doesn't make me innocent it is the lord who judges me therefore judge nothing before the appointed time wait"

3. 30 consecutive words - Sermon: The Faithfulness of God - 072626 | Source: Sexual Purity, Part 1 (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 2)

"you through and through may your whole spirit soul and body be kept blameless at the coming of our lord jesus christ the one who calls you is faithful and"

4. 26 consecutive words - Sermon: God's Word...Not Man's - 052426 | Source: God's Word... Not Man's (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"what advantage then is there in being a jew or what value is there in circumcision and we might expect him to say absolutely none but"

5. 25 consecutive words - Sermon: Our Glory and Joy - 053126 | Source: Our Glory and Joy (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"clear that paul was not only committed to the word of god but he was equally committed to the people of god and the pattern"

6. 25 consecutive words - Sermon: Our Glory and Joy - 053126 | Source: Our Glory and Joy (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"he thinks of these dear ones who have been brought to christ under the ministry that god has given him that they represent his hope"

7. 25 consecutive words - Sermon: Sexual Purity - 062826 | Source: Sexual Purity, Part 1 (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 2)

"exist in order that he might fulfill our aspirations but we exist in order that we might live to the praise of his glory and"

8. 24 consecutive words - Sermon: God's Word...Not Man's - 052426 | Source: God's Word... Not Man's (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"and we also thank god continually because when you receive the word of god which you heard from us you accepted it not as"

9. 24 consecutive words - Sermon: Our Glory and Joy - 053126 | Source: Our Glory and Joy (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"not in thought out of our intense longing we made every effort to see you for we wanted to come to you certainly i"

10. 23 consecutive words - Sermon: God's Word...Not Man's - 052426 | Source: God's Word... Not Man's (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"paul could preach with certainty and power for he had the profound conviction that what he said was not of man's devising but"

11. 22 consecutive words - Sermon: God's Word...Not Man's - 052426 | Source: God's Word... Not Man's (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"in this way they always heap up their sins to the limit the wrath of god has come upon them at last"

12. 22 consecutive words - Sermon: God's Word...Not Man's - 052426 | Source: God's Word... Not Man's (Alistair Begg, A Study in 1 Thessalonians, Volume 1)

"wish that i myself were cursed and cut off from christ for the sake of my brothers those of my own race"

Method and guardrails

- Normalise text, index every 8-word sequence in each source, extend matches while words stay identical, union matched positions.
- Overlap is not plagiarism: check spoken or printed attribution, licensing and shared source material.
- Speech-recognition errors suppress matches; figures are conservative.
- Set aside Scripture quotations; the source's own commentary, illustrations and transitions are the material evidence.